

easily understood. Aesthetics is a feeling in the player which tells whether the game is good or bad, even though the player might not have knowledge of Game Design principles.

As a player keeps playing the game, gradually he might start appreciating the dynamics of the game and now their experiences arise from these dynamics. After understanding the dynamics, the player might understand that they do or don't like the game due to the specific kinds of interactions they are having within the game. If the player spends a lot of time on a game, then they may eventually understand the mechanics involved in the game and understand how dynamics emerged from these mechanics.

A Game Designer has to understand that he has no direct control over changing the aesthetics and dynamics of the game. If at any point in a game the designer feels that there needs to be a change in a game to "make it more fun", then it can be made only by changing the mechanic.

Approaches that Game Designers follow for idea or concept generation

- ▶ **Blue-Sky approach:** This approach allows consider unlimited number of possibilities with no constraints at all. Generally, the Game Designers have constraints on budget, time. But, this approach assumes no constraint except the designer's imagination.
- ▶ **Slow-Boil:** In this approach, the designers decide a theme and stuff everything regarding this theme into their minds and wait for an idea to occur. This approach is sarcastically called slow boil, as it might take even years sometimes to come up with an idea with this approach.
- ▶ **Mechanic-Driven:** This is the most common approach used. Many famous games like Mario were born by this approach. Mario jumps onto, over and into things and the whole strength of the game lies in this mechanic and makes Mario what it is. Perhaps the largest mechanic-driven games feature the mechanic right in the genre's title: first-person shooters. The mechanic of firing a gun, a wand, or a something evidently never gets old. Even Mario could shoot fireballs.
- ▶ **The MDA approach:** Designers can use the MDA approach too. Think of an aesthetic you want to deliver, then think of the corresponding mechanics, dynamics and theme to it. This might be a very strong approach as it is player-centric.
- ▶ **IP: Sometimes,** Designers don't start with a new concept at all. Most Designers find themselves developing a sequel to the pre-existing game. Intellectual property is an idea or a collection of ideas that is